Table 3—Gap in Four-Year College Enrollment between High- and Low-Income Students

	Control group	Guidance group	Treatment effect	% change
Gap between high- and low-income students	0.305	0.185	−0.121	−40%
	(0.021)	(0.028)	(0.035)	
Explained by average test scores and high school FE	0.161	0.141	−0.020	−12%
	(0.015)	(0.019)	(0.024)	
Unexplained by average test scores and high school FE	0.145	0.044	−0.101	−70%
	(0.021)	(0.024)	(0.032)	

Notes: The table reports the gap in four-year college enrollment between high- and low-income students in both the control and career guidance groups. Each gap is decomposed into a part that can be explained by students' academic preparation as measured by students' average test scores in Grade 9 and high school fixed effects, and a part that cannot. The decomposition is performed using a traditional Kitagawa-Oaxaca-Blinder decomposition using, as the reference coefficients, the coefficients from a pooled regression.

average test scores in grade 9 and high school fixed effects, and a part that cannot. See Supplemental Appendix C for more details on the methodology and some robustness checks. The table displays two major findings. First, it indicates that, in the absence of the interventions, the gap in four-year college enrollment between high- and low-income students is substantial—30 percentage points wide—and that roughly 50 percent of it *cannot* be explained by differences in academic preparation between the two types of students. Second, it shows that the career guidance intervention was able to narrow the unexplained gap by 70 percent—from 14 to 4 percentage points—such that, in the career guidance group, most of the difference in four-year college enrollment between high- and low-income students is explained by differences in academic preparation.[13]

B. *Long-Term Outcomes*

What happens to these students in the long run? To answer this question, in Table 4 I present the treatment effects of the three interventions on college completion and on labor income in early adulthood (27–29 years old). In addition, Figure 1 details the evolution of the treatment effects on income over time from age 18 to 29. All outcomes are presented for the full sample of students, i.e., are unconditional on college enrollment or employment. Additional results on the effects of the interventions on the probability of being employed and on income and industry conditional on working are also presented in Supplemental Appendix Table E.13.

First, I find that the guidance intervention increased the share of low-income students who graduated from a four-year college by 4.8 percentage points and the share of low-income students who dropped out of college by 3.6 percentage points. It suggests that some, but not all, of the students induced to enroll in a four-year college by the intervention were successful in completing college.

I also investigate the effects of the program on individuals' annual labor income in adulthood. The guidance intervention initially decreased students' labor income

[13] I find similar results when decomposing the gap between very high-income and very low-income families in Supplemental Appendix Table C.7.